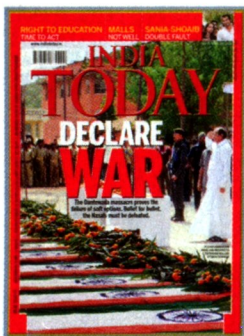


# Declare War

APRIL 19, 2010

The horrific killing of 76 CRPF jawans in a Maoist ambush at Dantewada underlines the failure of soft options. India needs to forge a long-term strategy to eradicate Maoism.



“ Looking at the way the anti-Naxal Operation Green Hunt has come unstuck, it would appear that professionalism, common sense and forethought were barely kept in mind while planning the operation. ”

LT-COL (RETD) B.K. NAUTIYAL, via [www.indiatoday.in](http://www.indiatoday.in)

## Taming the Reds

The Government seems keen to mollycoddle the Maoists and is hesitant to use the Army or Air Force to decimate these terrorists who have been waging a relentless war against the state (“Declare War”, April 19). Men in powerful positions are making asinine statements that we should be careful as these are our own citizens. It is time to rip the mask off the movement which preaches no other doctrine except violence. The means now no longer matter, it is only the end which matters.

C.V. ARAVIND,

via [www.indiatoday.in](http://www.indiatoday.in)

While the well-trained rebels are ready to exact their toll with various sophisticated weapons, our forces are woefully ill-



## Twisted Path

How can one explain the RTE's provisions such as multi-layered schooling, multi-grade classes, denial of free education and the neo-liberal guru Milton Friedman's school vouchers for 25 per cent of seats in private schools (“Hard Act to Follow”, April 19)? Yet private schools, supported through PPP out of government funds, IT exemptions and low-interest loans, would have the freedom to hike fees, appoint underpaid teachers and increase profits. No country has succeeded in universalising school education without a Common School System based on neighbourhood schools and India won't be an exception. Ironically, neither the MPs who voted for the Act nor the activists would send their children to the sub-standard schools specified by the norms of the law. This is notwithstanding Kapil Sibal's hyperbole of calling the Act a “twist with destiny” and the prime minister's moving childhood memories of studying under a roadside lamp.

ANIL SADGOPAL, former senior fellow,  
Nehru Memorial Museum and Library

equipped with antiquated .303 rifles. There is an urgent need to ensure concrete action from the affected state governments to counter the well-armed insurgents. Deploying our Central security forces immediately in the war zone by providing mine detectors, jammers, night vision goggles, radars, walkie-talkies, bullet-proof jackets and other such sophisticated warfare material will definitely help them combat the Maoists effectively.

IPPILI SANTHOSH KUMAR,  
Srikakulam

The Dantewada episode has exposed the failure of the present strategy of the Government to counter the Maoist menace. Sending an ill-equipped and untrained CRPF to the Maoist stronghold is like sending

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